

BEATRIZ GIETNER

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Research Profile

Applied microeconomist working on human capital formation and inequality over the life course. My research studies how schools and labour markets convert early advantages into later outcomes. My dissertation uses evidence from Ireland and Japan, combining longitudinal cohort data, household panel data, decomposition methods, and event-time designs. My broader agenda sits between economics of education and labour economics, with a comparative interest in East Asian institutions.

Research Interests

Applied microeconomics; economics of education; labour economics; human capital; educational inequality; gender gaps; family and labour-market institutions; East Asian labour markets; longitudinal data.

Education

PhD in Economics, University College Dublin *2020–2026 expected*
Dissertation: *Essays on Inequality in Education and Labour Markets*
Supervisor: Professor Kevin Denny

M.Ed. in Science Education, Trinity College Dublin *2018*

Lic. in Physics, Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina *2013*

BSc in Physics, Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina *2012*

Research Papers

The Dual Labour Market and the Motherhood Employment Penalty in Japan

Using the Japan Household Panel Survey and Keio Household Panel Survey, this paper studies employment around first birth in Japan. The evidence shows a sharp employment drop at the birth-report wave, limited near pre-birth decline, and strong stratification by labour-market tier. Non-regular contract status predicts employment exit at childbirth. Later employment recovery masks persistent downgrading in full-time attachment, hours, and earnings. The paper is descriptive rather than causal and interprets the evidence through Japan's dual labour-market structure.

When Do Gender Gaps in Maths Become Skill Gaps? Evidence from Ireland

Using Growing Up in Ireland, this paper studies the gender gap in Leaving Certificate Maths. It compares Oaxaca-Blinder and distributional decompositions using predictors measured at age 9 and age 13. The same later achievement gap has a different structure across developmental stages. With age-9 predictors, the gap is mainly coefficient-dominant. With age-13 predictors, it becomes mainly endowment-dominant, driven by measured numeracy. An English comparison reverses this pattern, suggesting that the timing shift is subject-specific.

Cognitive Ability, Attentional Regulation, and Academic Achievement

Using Growing Up in Ireland, this paper examines how cognitive ability and attentional regulation at age 13 predict Junior Certificate Maths and English outcomes, controlling for age-9 baseline measures. The main finding is a negative interaction. The estimated return to cognitive ability is larger for students with weaker attentional regulation. The result survives baseline controls, multiple-testing adjustment, cross-informant checks, and sensitivity tests. The evidence points to a school-proximal behavioural construct rather than a generic noncognitive measure.

Research Agenda

Comparative work on education systems, achievement gaps, and human capital formation across institutional settings.

Research agenda on East Asian education and labour markets, building on my Japan household-panel work and earlier Korea-related research assistance.

Methodological writing on applied causal inference and Difference-in-Differences through *DiD Digest*.

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, Public Choice, Dublin City University

Spring 2025/26

Designed and delivered undergraduate teaching in public choice, political economy, and policy analysis; prepared teaching materials; assessed student work.

Teaching Assistant / Tutor, University College Dublin

2020–2024

Teaching across undergraduate and postgraduate economics modules, including MSc Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics: Microeconometrics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Macroeconomics for Business, Microeconomics for Business, Game Theory, and Industrial Economics.

High School Teacher, Physics and General Science

2014–2016

Taught physics and general science at secondary-school level.

Selected Presentations

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| 2026 | 8th Annual Conference of the Japan Economy Network, Tokyo, Japan. |
| 2026 | 3rd International Doctoral Forum, Beijing, China. |
| 2026 | 11th LEER Conference on Education Economics, Leuven, Belgium (<i>Invited</i>). |
| 2026 | Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education, Lisbon, Portugal (<i>Invited</i>). |
| 2025 | 2nd International Doctoral Forum, Beijing, China. |
| 2025 | Public Choice Outreach Conference, Fairfax, USA. |
| 2025 | ISWE Conference on Diversity, Economics and Society, Dublin, Ireland. |
| 2025 | ESCoE Conference on Economic Measurement, London, UK. |
| 2025 | Young Economists' Meeting, Brno, Czech Republic (<i>Invited</i>). |
| 2025 | 10th LEER Conference on Education Economics, Leuven, Belgium. |
| 2024 | Growing Up in Ireland Annual Conference, Dublin, Ireland. |
| 2024 | Progress Conference: Toward Abundant Futures, Berkeley, USA. |
| 2024 | Causal Inference OCE Conference III, Chicago, USA. |
| 2022–2026 | Irish Economic Association Annual Conference. |

Advanced Training and Workshops

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| 2024 | AV's Difference-in-Differences Workshop, San Francisco, USA. Supported by Arnold Ventures. |
| 2024 | ISEG Summer School: Machine Learning for Prediction and Causal Analysis, Lisbon, Portugal. |
| 2024 | Optimization-Conscious Econometrics Summer School, Chicago, USA. Supported by the Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics, University of Chicago. |

Awards, Grants, and Selected Programmes

Emergent Ventures Grant for <i>DiD Digest</i>	2025–2026
ISWE Mentorship Programme	2025–2026
AMIE Mentoring Programme	2024–2025
UCD School of Economics Scholarship	2020–2025

Research Communication and Public Writing

Founder and Author, *DiD Digest* 2025–present

Public newsletter on Difference-in-Differences and applied causal inference. The newsletter summarises recent methodological work in clear language for researchers and policy-facing readers. Supported by a \$10,000 Emergent Ventures grant.

Korea-Related Experience

Korean language study; research assistance on Korea-related cultural research; Portuguese-language translation and survey-analysis support for CedarBough T. Saeji, “Building a K-Community: Idol Stars Challenging Foreign Fans to Learn Korean Traditions,” *Acta Koreana*, 25(2), 2022. Acknowledged research-team contribution.

Software and Technical Skills

R and Stata for empirical research; Quarto/R Markdown and L^AT_EX for reproducible writing; Git/GitHub for version control; Python, Codex CLI, and Claude Code for research workflows and code assistance.

Languages and Additional Information

Languages	Portuguese: native; English: fluent; Spanish: advanced; Korean: conversational; Japanese: beginner.
Citizenship	Brazil, Italy.
Policy interests	Education policy; labour-market inequality; social protection; evidence-informed public decision-making.

References

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